

you have to include the CoffeeScript compiler on your Web page. You can download the compiler from the CoffeeScript website.

Now let us look at how to use CoffeeScript in your Web page. Open your text editor and type the following code:

```
<html>
<head>
<meta charset="utf-8">
<title>Names</title>
</head>
<body>
<script src="coffee-script.js" type="text/javascript"></script>
<script type="text/CoffeeScript">
name = prompt "What is your First Name?"
name2= prompt "What is your Last Name?"
fullname=name + name2
alert "Hello, #{fullname}"
</script>
</body></html>
```

Please note that in the 7th line, I've included the CoffeeScript compiler in the coding. Now save this file in your Web server and run it. You will see that CoffeeScript runs in your browser.

The advantages of CoffeeScript

CoffeeScript has numerous advantages over JavaScript. I am pointing out a few important ones here.

1. Very little coding is involved when programming in CoffeeScript, as compared to JavaScript.
2. All the good features of JavaScript are present in CoffeeScript.
3. You don't have to debug any “}” in your script.
4. You can use any existing JavaScript library seamlessly with CoffeeScript.
5. With the proper use of whitespace you can make your script more readable as well as maintainable.

The disadvantages of CoffeeScript

CoffeeScript has only a few disadvantages. When you're



Figure 1: CoffeeScript in action

using CoffeeScript, there's an additional compilation step involved in the process, but Jeremy Ashkenas says that the CoffeeScript team is trying to mitigate this in the future. Another limitation is that there are only a few resources available for this language, but when you want to learn CoffeeScript, the *coffeescript.org* website is a great place to start. You can find many examples and also resources available for CoffeeScript.

The final word

CoffeeScript is targeted at JavaScript programmers. Its sole purpose is to remove all the rough edges from JavaScript and provide a smooth way of programming in JavaScript. CoffeeScript can be fairly simple to programmers who began with JavaScript and also to the people who have a background in Python and Ruby background. But those who have a background in C or Java might feel a little different. Still, CoffeeScript is definitely worth a shot for every programmer. Now, programming in JavaScript has an easy way and a hard way - the choice is yours. **END** 

References

- [1] [1. http://coffeescript.org/](http://coffeescript.org/)
- [2] <http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Coffeescript>
- [3] 'CoffeeScript: Accelerated JavaScript Development' by Trevor Burnham

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